Before-and-After Proofreading Sample

Example of improving grammar, clarity, and academic tone

Purpose

This sample demonstrates proofreading support. The writer's original idea is retained; the revision improves wording, punctuation, sentence structure, and flow.

Before: Original Draft

Oral hygiene is very important because if people dont brush there teeth food can remain in the mouth and it can cause bacteria. This bacteria causes cavities and gum disease, students should brush everyday morning and night because it will make their teeth healthy.

After: Proofread Version

Oral hygiene is important because food particles can remain in the mouth when teeth are not brushed properly. These particles contribute to the growth of bacteria, which can increase the risk of tooth decay and gum disease. Students should brush their teeth every morning and night to help maintain healthy teeth and gums.

What Was Improved

Area	Examples of improvements
Grammar and word choice	Changed "dont" to "do not," "there teeth" to "their teeth," and "This bacteria" to "These particles contribute to the gro
Clarity	Separated several ideas into clearer sentences and explained the link between food particles, bacteria, and diseas
Punctuation	Added full stops and commas where needed.
Academic tone	Replaced informal wording such as "it will make their teeth healthy" with a clearer, more professional phrase.

Proofreading Checklist

- Check spelling, grammar, punctuation, and capital letters.
- Make sure each sentence is complete and clear.
- Keep the writer's original meaning and voice.
- Check that claims needing sources have citations.
- Check headings, font, spacing, and reference-list consistency.

Professional boundary: Proofreading improves a writer's existing work; it does not mean writing graded work for them.

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